



1

Define

Define the project's purpose and scope; identify processes that need improvement; determine customer needs and benefits.

Striving for perfection

The DMAIC methodology (standing for Define, Measure, Analyze, Improve, Control) is an integral part of Six Sigma. It is used for improving existing business processes that are falling below targets and where step-by-step improvements can be made.

2

Measure

Use data on current processes as a baseline; pinpoint problem locations and occurrences; identify potential areas for improvement.

3

Analyze

Identify root causes of problems and check them against data; determine precise improvements that need to be made.

CHAMPIONS

Mobile-phone maker Motorola used Six Sigma quality as a goal for its manufacturing operations; CEO and chairman Jack Welch made it central to his business strategy at General Electric in the 1990s; tech company Dell has used a form of Six Sigma since 2000 and is now the model for many other businesses.

 $\frac{2}{3}$

of Fortune 500
US organizations
were running Six
Sigma initiatives
by the late 1990s,
with the goal
of improving
quality and
reducing costs